

MICHELLE DUELL

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Professional Summary

Security analyst and researcher with an active TS/SCI clearance, currently conducting adversarial testing of frontier AI systems as a senior AI safety evaluator. Eight years of operational targeting and multi-source intelligence experience, a published 16-report threat intelligence series, and podium finishes in national cybersecurity competitions. Seeking threat hunting, threat intelligence, incident response, SOC, detection engineering, and AI red teaming roles.

Certifications

CSA Trusted AI Safety Expert (TAISE) | 2026
GIAC Certified Incident Handler (GCIH) | 2026
GIAC Security Essentials (GSEC) | 2025
GIAC Foundational Cybersecurity Technologies (GFACT) | 2025
GIAC Advisory Board (90%+ exam score) | 2025

Professional Experience

Senior AI Safety Evaluator | Handshake AI | Remote (Contract) | Jul 2026 to Present

- Test frontier AI models against their safety limits through structured red teaming, probing model behavior against safety policies and documenting reproducible findings
- Completed 600+ tasks spanning red teaming, conversation evaluations, and harm assessments

AI Workflow Engineer & Threat Content Analyst (Volunteer) | KC7 Foundation | Remote | 2026 to Present

- Designed and built an agentic LLM pipeline of 45+ specialized agents, cutting threat scenario production time from roughly three weeks to roughly three hours
- Authored AeroDrift Motors, a published KC7 game at the Challenging difficulty level
- Review threat scenarios and investigative workflows for technical accuracy before publication, validating that attacker techniques reflect realistic TTPs and that investigative steps reproduce as written
- Contributed to 6+ published games on KC7's free cybersecurity education platform, authoring threat scenarios and investigative workflows

Security Analyst & Researcher (Independent) | Remote | 2025 to Present

- Deployed T-Pot Community Edition on GCP for 28 days, collecting 96M+ events across a fully exposed attack surface, querying raw Elasticsearch data daily to track CVE exploitation trends, active campaigns, and credential attack patterns, and publishing a 16-report CTI series at aerobytes.io
- Completed 27 end-to-end intrusion investigations (400+ hours) on the KC7 cyber platform, pivoting through email, DNS, endpoint, and authentication telemetry with KQL in Azure Data Explorer to reconstruct full attack chains, publishing writeups of 3 investigations
- Test web applications on live in-scope bug bounty programs using browser developer tools and manual analysis, informed by OWASP Top 10 vulnerability classes, with active researcher accounts on Bugcrowd and HackerOne

Intelligence Analyst | U.S. Army Reserve | Norfolk, VA | 2018 to Present | TS/SCI Clearance

- Conduct strategic and operational-level targeting as Joint Intelligence Targeting Staff (J2T) member supporting combatant command operations
- Lead Joint Targeting Team of 9 personnel, coordinating cross-functional intelligence production and delivering targeting packages to operational commanders
- Conduct multi-source data correlation to identify adversary TTPs, synthesizing classified and open-source intelligence into actionable threat assessments

Cybersecurity Projects & Skills

- **LLM Red Team MCP Server** | Built an original Python MCP server (github.com/aeronique/llm-redteam-mcp) that runs adversarial prompt probes against local Ollama models, with 47 passing tests
- **AeroLab v2** | Designed and deployed a segmented purple team environment across two Proxmox nodes with pfSense, Windows Server 2022 with intentionally misconfigured Active Directory, Elastic SIEM 9.x, and Velociraptor, executing ATT&CK-mapped adversary emulations of identity attacks with MITRE Caldera and analyzing the attack telemetry in Elastic SIEM
- **Ghidra Function ID Pipeline** | Built a repeatable pipeline generating Ghidra Function ID databases for glibc across four Ubuntu releases (29,578 functions), raising named functions in a stripped test binary from 7 to 144

CTF & Cybersecurity Competition Results

- **1st Place Overall & 1st Place Industry Professional** | 2026 WiCyS Conference CTF
- **1st Place** | 2026 Tenable x WiCyS CTF
- **2nd Place** | 2026 Elastic Security CTF
- **2nd Place** | 2025 WiCyS x Target Cyber Defense Challenge
- **5th Place & Runner-Up Most Creative Report** | 2025 SANS Holiday Hack Challenge

Speaking Engagements

“Reverse Engineering with Ghidra for DNS Exfiltration”

- WiCyS 2026 National Conference | Washington, DC | 2026
- WiCyS San Diego Cyber Speaker Series | Virtual | 2026

Technical Writing & Publications

Published 35+ technical writeups at aerobytes.io/writeups covering CTF solutions, honeypot findings, blockchain security research, and homelab infrastructure, including a 16-report threat intelligence series.

Education

SANS Cyber Academy | SANS Technology Institute | 2026

Undergraduate Certificate, Computers and Networking | American Military University | 2022

Associate of Applied Science, Intelligence Operations | Cochise College | 2019

Master of Music Education and Bachelor of Music Performance | Lamar University

Professional Affiliations

VetSec | WiCyS Representative | 2025 - Present

Women in CyberSecurity (WiCyS) | 2025 - Present

Military Cyber Professionals Association | 2025 - Present

Military Intelligence Corps Association | 2018 - Present

Other Work Experience

OSINT Researcher (Volunteer) | National Geospatial-Intelligence Agency | GEMINI Program | 2020 to Present

- Utilized Overpass API and OpenStreetMap to query and validate geospatial datasets, contributing 5,000+ map edits supporting critical infrastructure mapping and intelligence community requirements
- Designed and administered 15 critical infrastructure mapping campaigns to sustain team readiness and support operational intelligence

Music Educator and Professional Musician | Various Organizations | 2004 to 2015

- Led a band program of approximately 500 students, earning multiple regional and state recognitions
- Performed as Assistant Principal Clarinet in three professional symphony orchestras